

Question:
At birth, the least developed part of the brain is the

Answer Choices:

- A. visual system
- B. thalamus
- C. frontal lobe
- D. brain stem
- E. parietal lobe
- F. cerebellum
- G. cortex
- H. basal ganglia
- I. hypothalamus
- J. limbic system

Reasoning + Answer:

< reasoning process here >

At birth , the brain undergoes rapid development , with certain regions developing earlier than others . The brain stem , which controls basic life -sustaining functions like breathing and heart rate , is one of the first structures to develop and is present at birth . The cere bellum and the brain stem are among the earliest structures to form , but the most developed structures in terms of functional maturity at birth are the brain stem and the brain stem-related structures .

However , the question asks for the *least developed* part of the brain at birth .

The frontal lobe , which is responsible for higher cognitive functions such as decision-making , planning , and executive control , is one of the last brain regions to mature . It undergoes significant development throughout childhood and adolescence . In contrast , the brain stem , thalamus , hypothalamus , and limbic system are more developed at birth or develop earlier .

Therefore , the frontal lobe is the least developed at birth , as it is the last to mature structurally and functionally .

Answer choice C : frontal lobe is the correct choice .

< answer > C </answer >

